



PROJECT TASKS (Step-by-Step)

◆ Phase 1 – Configure System-Wide Default Policy

1 Configure default password aging

Edit:

/etc/login.defs

Set:

```
PASS_MAX_DAYS 60
PASS_MIN_DAYS 7
PASS_WARN_AGE 10
```

2 Configure Password Complexity

Edit:

/etc/security/pwquality.conf

Set:

```
minlen = 12
dcredit = -1
ucredit = -1
lcredit = -1
ocredit = -1
maxrepeat = 3
```

3 Prevent Password Reuse

Edit PAM config:

RHEL/CentOS:

/etc/pam.d/system-auth

Ubuntu:

/etc/pam.d/common-password

Add:

password required pam_pwhistory.so remember=5

4 Configure Account Lockout Policy

Edit:

/etc/pam.d/system-auth

Add:

auth required pam_faillock.so preauth silent deny=5 unlock_time=900
auth required pam_faillock.so authfail deny=5 unlock_time=900

◆ Phase 2 – Configure Default User Settings

Check:

useradd -D

Ensure:

- Default shell: `/bin/bash`
- Inactive days: 30

Set if needed:

sudo useradd -D -f 30

◆ Phase 3 – Create Users

Create all users with:

- Home directory

- Bash shell
- Force password change at first login

Example:

```
sudo useradd -m -s /bin/bash emp01
sudo passwd emp01
sudo chage -d 0 emp01
```

◆ Phase 4 – Configure Account Expiry for Temporary Users

Set expiry:

```
sudo chage -E 2026-12-31 intern01
sudo chage -E 2026-12-31 contractor01
sudo chage -E 2026-12-31 auditor01
```

◆ Phase 5 – Apply Policy to Existing Users

Apply aging policy:

```
for user in $(awk -F: '($3 >= 1000 {print $1})' /etc/passwd); do
  sudo chage -M 60 -m 7 -W 10 $user
done
```

Phase 6 – Verification (Audit Mode)

For each user check:

```
chage -l username
passwd -S username
id username
```

Check:

- ✓ Password expiry
 - ✓ Warning days
 - ✓ Account expiry
 - ✓ Inactive days
 - ✓ Lock policy works
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Phase 7 – Security Testing

Test 1: Password Complexity

Try weak password → Should fail.

Test 2: Password Reuse

Change password 5 times → Try old one → Should fail.

Test 3: Failed Login

Enter wrong password 5 times → Account should lock.

Check:

```
faillock --user username
```

Unlock manually:

```
faillock --user username --reset
```



Final Audit Checklist

Item	Status
Password expires 60 days	✓
Min age 7 days	✓
Warning 10 days	✓

- Complexity enforced 
 - Password reuse blocked 
 - Lock after 5 attempts 
 - Temporary users expire 
 - Inactive auto-disable 
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